

Adobe's Narayan: Firefly to unlock new era of creativity

The Adobe CEO was speaking at Adobe MAX 2025

At MAX 2025, happening in Los Angeles, Adobe CEO Shantanu Narayan said creativity is entering a new era" as the company unveiled its most expansive set of AI-powered tools yet.

"We are investing in creativity to ensure that creators move faster and create more," Narayan said. "With Firefly, you have more options now, and our vision is to make it a one-stop solution from ideation to creation."

Firefly now serves as an all-in-one creative hub, integrating AI tools for audio, video, and design alongside new Firefly Boards, which is a collaborative ideation space for creators and professionals. Each Firefly model will have



SHANTANU NARAYEN
CEO, Adobe

its own "character," Narayan noted, allowing users to work across Adobe apps without switching contexts.

"Our new generative AI features will allow creators to have pixel-level per-

fection," he said, highlighting Firefly's ability to produce end-to-end video, compose soundtracks and voiceovers, and edit thousands of images in bulk through Firefly Creative Production.

Adobe also infused Creative Cloud apps with new AI-powered capabilities such as Generative Fill and Generative Upscale in Photoshop, and AI Object Mask in Premiere. These tools, Narayan said, are designed to enhance and not replace human creativity.

"It's the creators who bring the creativity which cannot be replaced," he added.

Alongside its proprietary Firefly models, Adobe now supports AI models from Google, OpenAI, Runway, and others, giving creators flexibility to choose the best fit for their projects.

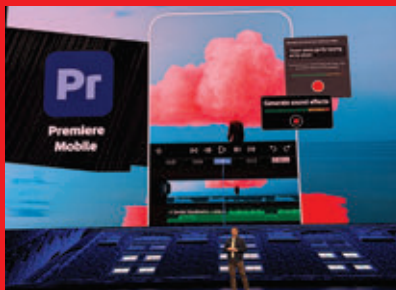
Adobe's AI assistants, powered by conversational and agentic AI, are being integrated directly into Firefly, Photoshop and Adobe Express to help anyone turn ideas into content through simple natural language prompts. **d**

Adobe reveals Premiere Pro for mobile

With built-in support for YouTube Shorts

In a big push for short form content, Adobe and YouTube are teaming up, to make it easier and faster for creators to edit and upload their content on the platform. At MAX 2025, executives from both companies took stage to announce the new Adobe Premiere mobile app, which was launched for iPhones last month, will soon have a dedicated "Create for YouTube Shorts" workspace.

The new feature will let users access Adobe's pro-grade video-editing tools directly inside the YouTube ecosystem. Creators will be able to tap an "Edit in Adobe Premiere" icon within the YouTube Shorts app, opening a streamlined editing interface that includes exclusive effects, transitions, and title presets tailored for Shorts.



Inside the Premiere mobile app, the Create for YouTube Shorts section will also feature a library of ready-to-use templates. These will include day-in-the-life vlogs, travel montages and get-ready-with-me formats, among others. The users will also be allowed to customise these templates to create more personalised videos and publish to YouTube Shorts.

The partnership should provide a big push to YouTube Shorts, giving it an advantage over other platforms like Instagram Reels and TikTok (now banned in India).

While the Premiere mobile app is free to download, access to AI-powered features like Firefly-based generative tools and auto-generated sound effects will remain part of Adobe's paid subscription plans.